

(Printed with the demonstration version of Fade In)

FATHER FIGURE **(Duologue)**

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FADE IN:

EXT. UNIVERSITY - LOVE GARDEN - DAY

The gentle breeze collides with the indistinctive chattering among the students sitting around the garden. **MODOLA (28, Tomboy, unkempt)** taps her feet on the floor, with her arms crossed, tense. On the same seat is **YINKA (25, well-groomed)** fiddles with the novel in his hands as he tilt to the opposite direction, frowning.

Moments after, two girls **walk** towards Yinka, grinning. Modola clears her throat loudly, with a stern look. The girls look at her and walk away, frightened. Yinka sighs out, frustrated.

Modola unzips her bag and brings out a pack of cigarette. Yinka looks at her, pissed.

YINKA
(low tone)
I'm sure you understand the concept
of self-respect.

Yinka **hisses**.

MODOLA
How that one take concern me?

YINKA
It means you can't and you won't
smoke that nonsense while I'm still
here.
(beat)
You requested for 10 minutes. You
have just 4 left.

MODOLA
Olayinka. Are you ashamed of me?

Silence ensues as Yinka looks away, still **frowning**.

MODOLA (cont'd)
You own no right to and as long as
I'm one sponsoring your education,
you won't dare disrespect me!

Yinka **chuckles** and **faces** her, **staring** at her intently.

YINKA
The last I checked, respect is
earned, not inherited. I have class
in 5 minutes. Why did you call me?

MODOLA

You visited that man yet again, even after I banned you from seeing him.

YINKA

(chuckles)

Banned? Interesting! You know, one would think that you actually know what you are doing. Giving that you always want to stand so tall and untouchable. Is it my own father you are addressing as that man?

Modola dramatically **removes** her bag from her neck.

MODOLA

Come! You dey mad? You dey craze? Wetin dey work you? Who you be? Oh! So you think you can toy with my leniency on you? I raised you. I still feed you. I own you and we swore together not to ever give him a chance to come back into our lives.

YINKA

Do you even know why he left?

MODOLA

(yells)

I don't give a bloody damn! You want to start lecturing me on why a weak man left his children?

YINKA

If you can my father weak, then I can call our mother the weakest. I didn't grow up to know her either. She didn't even witness my second birthday.

Modola shakes her head, disappointed.

MODOLA

This man has poisoned your mind already. He did nothing for us! I dropped out so you can further.

YINKA

You chose to! Did I beg you?

Modola's **jaw drops**, shocked. **Silence** ensues for a bit.

YINKA (cont'd)
I've been in touch with him for years. He wants to come back but no, my almighty sister wants to be heroin of the whole story by shouldering all the responsibilities... even when no one asked.

(beats)
He sends me money every months. I've given you some out of it or do you think I depend on your 5k weekly stipend?

Yinka **chuckles**.

YINKA (cont'd)
Look around, your mates are already graduating. I think it's high time you took your life serious and get back on track.

MODOLA
(shaky voice)
Yinka.

YINKA
Listen. It's really hard for me navigating this... this life without a father figure. Look at you...

Modola **scans** herself, stunned.

YINKA (cont'd)
You look tattered and weird. I simply can't regard you as a mother, let alone a father figure. We need him and I need you to know that I want the best for you and I.

Modola **scratches** her hair rigorously, triggered.

YINKA (cont'd)
I'll leave you to make your own decision. I have made mine and nothing can change it.

Yinka gets up, **adjust** his cloth and **exhales**.

YINKA (cont'd)
Also, whatever decision you make today, it's going to tell on you in few years... Oh! It's even telling already.

Yinka **checks** his watch and makes a **gentle nod**.

YINKA (cont'd)
I'll see you... when I see you. Oh!
You can light your comfort now.

He walks away. Modola leans back on the chair, fidgets for a few moments, brings out the **cigarette**. Her hand trembles as she squeezes the pack and scream out.

FADE OUT